

Modeling Sales Expansion

for Small & Medium Food-and-Beverage Brands

Entering new international markets with data-driven confidence

A portfolio project by frazbama

Data Analytics · Digital Marketing · International Trade

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Companion to the Trueleaf Provisions Power BI dashboard — an eleven-page interactive analysis of an alternative-sweeteners brand modeling its expansion from North America into the UAE, UK, and Saudi Arabia.

What This Project Demonstrates

My work sits at the intersection of three disciplines I have built over two decades: international trade, digital marketing, and data analytics. This project shows how I bring them together to solve a specific, high-stakes problem — helping small and medium food-and-beverage brands decide when, where, and how to expand into new international markets.

Expansion into unfamiliar territories is where F&B brands most often win big or lose badly. A brand that thrives at home can stumble abroad because the economics of a new market — acquisition costs, return behaviour, channel structure, import duties, consumer purchasing power — are different and frequently invisible until it is too late. My role is to make those economics visible before the capital is committed, so that founders and growth leaders can act on evidence rather than instinct.

In a global trade environment that shifts constantly and grows steadily more complex — with tariffs, compliance requirements, and shifting corridors reshaping the map from one quarter to the next — it becomes all the more imperative for brands to have the skills and the ability to win international shelf space deliberately. That means moving with confidence, executing the right entry strategy, and mitigating the risks that come with unfamiliar markets, rather than being deterred by them. Data analysis is what converts that uncertainty into a manageable, evidence-based plan.

The Trueleaf Provisions dashboard is a worked example of that approach. It follows an alternative-sweeteners brand — established across Canada, the United States, and Mexico — as it weighs entry into three riskier but potentially lucrative markets: the United Arab Emirates, the United Kingdom, and Saudi Arabia. Every page answers a question a real decision-maker would ask, and ends by stating what the data means for the strategy.

How I Model F&B Market Expansion

Rather than producing a static report, I build an interactive decision instrument. The analysis is designed so a founder or head of growth can explore the trade-offs themselves — not just read a conclusion. The modeling rests on four pillars:

- **Market attractiveness scoring** establishes how attractive each target market is, scored from disposable income, e-commerce penetration, import duty, category size, and competitive density — so markets are ranked by evidence, not proximity or gut feel.
- **Entry-economics simulation** lets a decision-maker drag levers for marketing investment and target acquisition cost, then watch projected revenue, break-even timing, and first-year ROI recalculate live — turning a spreadsheet assumption into an explorable scenario.
- **Revenue-quality analysis** examines what happens after the sale, exposing where returns and thin margins quietly erode headline revenue, so a brand fixes quality problems before scaling spend behind them.
- **Predictive channel health** ranks each sales channel by a composite health score, revealing whether a channel's reach justifies its cost structure — often producing counter-intuitive but defensible conclusions.

Taken together, these give a brand a clear line of sight from “which market first?” through “what will entry cost and when does it pay back?” to “which channels and products should carry the expansion?”

Grounded in the Google Data Analytics Process

The project is structured around the six-phase framework from the Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate. This is not decoration — it is the discipline that keeps the analysis honest and repeatable, and it is the same process I apply to real client engagements.

Phase	How it applies in this project
Ask	Frame the expansion decision. How attractive is each target market (UAE, UK, Saudi Arabia), what does entry cost, and where does revenue quality break down?
Prepare	Assemble the data model — sales, ad spend, returns, market-potential indices, and channel economics — into a clean, related star schema.
Process	Build the calculation layer in DAX: KPIs, CAC/ROAS, return rates, margin measures, and market-attractiveness scoring, all context-responsive.
Analyze	Surface the patterns — channel-mix differences across markets, acquisition efficiency by platform, margin erosion from returns, and predictive channel-health ranking.
Share	Communicate through an eleven-page dashboard with a deliberate story arc, stakeholder personas, and an insight box on every page that states the 'so what.'
Act	Translate findings into decisions — which market to enter first, which channels to scale, which product lines to fix before scaling spend behind them.

Working this way means the analysis is auditable at every step. A stakeholder can trace any figure on the dashboard back through the measure that produced it, the data that fed it, and the question it was built to answer.

Dimension One: Digital Marketing & Sales Outcomes

Data analysis is most valuable when it connects to the levers a brand can actually pull. Because I run digital marketing campaigns that generate real sales, I built the acquisition and marketing economics directly into this project rather than treating them as an afterthought.

The dashboard measures the outcomes of digital marketing strategy the way a growth leader needs to see them:

- **Acquisition efficiency:** customer acquisition cost and return on ad spend, broken down by platform — Amazon Ads, Google Ads, and Meta Ads — so spend can be steered toward what actually returns.
- **The marketing funnel:** a full view from impression to conversion, exposing where prospects drop off and which platforms convert most efficiently.
- **Repeat-purchase behaviour:** whether acquired customers come back, because a channel that buys one-time buyers is worth far less than one that builds a repeat base — a distinction that changes how much a brand should be willing to pay to acquire.

- **Spend as a live input:** in the entry simulator, marketing investment and target acquisition cost are the primary levers, making explicit how digital-marketing performance drives — or sinks — the economics of a new market.

This is the difference between an analyst who reports numbers and one who understands how the numbers are made. Because I have executed the campaigns, the analysis reflects how acquisition economics behave in practice, not just in theory.

Dimension Two: Channels, Categories & Cross-Market Insight

The second dimension examines how different sales channels and platforms affect different product categories — and how those relationships differ across the United States, Canada, and Mexico. Understanding the home-market patterns is what makes an international expansion strategy credible, because it reveals which channel-and-category combinations travel well and which are market-specific.

Why the channel-category-market interaction matters

A product category rarely performs uniformly across channels or countries. A line that sells beautifully through in-store retail in Canada may depend on marketplace visibility in the United States, or on distributor relationships in Mexico. The three markets in this analysis — despite sharing a continent — show materially different channel mixes, and those differences carry direct lessons for entering new territories abroad.

- **Channel mix by market:** the dashboard breaks revenue down by channel within each of the three established markets, so the structural differences between them are visible at a glance rather than buried in totals.
- **Category-level quality:** returns and margin quality are analysed by product category and by channel separately, revealing that a category's profitability can depend heavily on the channel it moves through.
- **Predictive channel scoring:** a composite health score ranks channels on margin, returns, commission cost, and scale together — surfacing, for example, that a high-reach marketplace can rank last once its commission is weighed against its margin.

From domestic patterns to international strategy

The value of comparing the US, Canada, and Mexico is that it builds a transferable model. Once a brand understands why its channel economics differ across three known markets, it can reason about a fourth. If in-store retail carries the strongest margin-and-returns profile domestically, that becomes a hypothesis to test in the UAE or UK — rather than a blind bet. The cross-market comparison turns scattered domestic data into a framework for expansion decisions abroad, which is precisely the judgement an F&B brand needs when the stakes and the uncertainty are highest.

The Objective

The purpose of this work is straightforward: **to help the decision-makers of food-and-beverage brands execute their sales and marketing strategies with confidence, by making the hidden economics of expansion visible before the capital is committed.** Business Intelligence tools are the means; identifying pain points and solving them is the end. This project is one demonstration of how I do that — combining international-trade experience, hands-on digital marketing, and rigorous data analysis into a single, decision-ready view.